

PM Planning with Adam (03/23/2026)

News for Today

- Construction Spending (MoM) (Jan) Forecast (0.1%) Previous (0.3%) (10:00AM)
 - 3-Month Bill Auction Previous (3.610%) (11:30AM)
 - 6-Month Bill Auction Previous (3.570%) (11:30AM)
 - Atlanta Fed GDPNow Forecast (2.3%) Previous (2.3%) (1:00PM)
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Market Overview — Monday, March 23, 2026

Futures Bounce

U.S. stock futures are moving lower to start the week as the Iran conflict stretches deeper into its fourth week, keeping pressure on global markets through elevated energy prices and rising inflation concerns.

Dow futures are down about 0.7%, S&P 500 futures are lower by 0.8%, and Nasdaq futures are leading to the downside, off 0.9%. The weakness follows a negative close last week, where equities struggled under the weight of surging oil prices and uncertainty around how long the conflict could last.

Oil Remains the Main Driver

Oil continues to be the most important factor in the market right now.

Brent crude is pushing above \$114 per barrel, a sharp increase from roughly \$70 before the conflict began. This surge is already feeding into the real economy, with U.S. gasoline prices rising significantly and adding pressure to overall inflation.

The concern for investors is straightforward — higher energy costs can slow consumer spending, compress corporate margins, and complicate the Federal Reserve's path forward on interest rates.

Focus on the Strait of Hormuz

At the center of the situation is the Strait of Hormuz, a critical global shipping route for oil.

With tanker traffic largely disrupted and Iran signaling it will not reopen the waterway, markets are increasingly pricing in a prolonged supply shock. Recent comments from U.S. leadership have suggested pressure to reopen the strait, but there is still no clear resolution in sight.

As long as this bottleneck remains constrained, oil markets are likely to stay volatile.

Energy Crisis Concerns Grow

The tone from global energy officials has become more serious.

The International Energy Agency has warned that the current situation could develop into a severe oil crisis, even after coordinated releases of strategic reserves. While these releases can provide temporary relief, they do not replace normal supply flows.

That's why oil prices continue to hold elevated levels despite intervention efforts.

Currency and Safe Haven Moves

The U.S. dollar is strengthening as investors move toward safety, reflecting broader risk-off sentiment across markets.

At the same time, gold prices are slipping. Instead of acting as a traditional safe haven, gold is being pressured by rising interest rate expectations and a stronger dollar, which reduces its appeal.

This shift suggests markets are becoming more focused on inflation and policy implications rather than purely geopolitical risk.

Adam's Watchlist

- \$QQQ: Looking to go long off the 594.45's KL for a push up into the 596.36's KL and potentially the 600's KL. If we break below, I'll be going short off the 590.19's KL for a push down into the 587.89's KL and potentially the 583.68's KL.
- \$RBRK: Looking to go long off the 51.17's KL for a push up into the 52.16's KL and potentially the 55's KL.
- \$MSFT: Looking to go long off the 397's KL for a push up into the 400's KL and potentially the 404.75's KL.
- \$DKNG: Looking to go long off the 25.26's KL for a push up into the 26.46's KL.
- \$COIN: Looking to go long off the 203.17's KL for a push up into the 209.19's KL and potentially the 213.73's KL
- \$TSLA: Looking to go long off the 373's KL for a push up into the 380.30's KL.

COMMUNITY WATCHLIST

- \$WRD: Looking to go long off the 7's KL for a push up into the 7.38's KL and potentially the 7.93's KL.